War Premium Returns

S&P −0.58%. Dow plunges 1.6%. Oil surges on tanker strike. Broadcom beats big after the bell.

THE SESSION

The war premium came back — hard. Wednesday's relief rally was erased in a single session as Iran's Revolutionary Guard claimed a missile strike on an American oil tanker in the northern Persian Gulf. The Dow plunged 1.61% — losing nearly 785 points — while the S&P 500 fell 0.58% to 6,829.91 and the Russell 2000 cratered 1.91%. The VIX surged 12.3% to 23.75. Gold fell 0.9% as the dollar strengthened. Bitcoin slid 1.6% to $71,502.

Semiconductors faced a double headwind: Bloomberg reported the U.S. is considering requiring permits for AI chip sales, and the war's energy shock continued to pressure the supply chain. LRCX dropped 3.73%, ADI fell 3.45%, NXPI lost 2.68%. KEYS plunged 5.45% as test equipment demand fears mounted. But the session's real story played out after hours — Broadcom crushed Q1 earnings with $2.05 EPS (vs. $1.88 est.), $19.3B revenue, and guided Q2 to $22B, nearly 7% above consensus. CEO Hock Tan declared line of sight to over $100B in AI chip revenue by 2027. AVGO surged 6% after the bell.

Hundreds of ships remain stuck in the Persian Gulf despite U.S. escort promises, and Iran has signaled it has enough drones to create havoc for months. Initial jobless claims held steady at 213,000 — labor market frozen. Nonfarm payrolls tomorrow; consensus expects 130K jobs with unemployment at 4.3%.

IOWN Tactical: S&P at ~6,830. Still well above our –20% buy trigger from ATH. Broadcom's $22B guide is the most bullish AI infrastructure signal since NVDA's GTC. Watch for semi names to gap up tomorrow on the AVGO halo.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

ADP +2.55% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

The day's standout. Payroll processing is immune to oil shocks and geopolitical risk. ADP hit $223.44 intraday — boring businesses shine in ugly sessions.

ATAT +2.08% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Atmus Filtration rallied on energy infrastructure demand. Industrial filtration benefits directly from elevated refining activity.

CVX +2.08% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Energy caught a bid as the tanker strike reignited supply-disruption fears. Chevron reversed yesterday's decline as crude surged.

FTNT +1.97% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Cybersecurity demand continues to benefit from the geopolitical backdrop. Third straight session of outperformance.

FAST +1.87% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Industrial distribution demand remains robust. Hit $48.41 intraday, its highest since mid-February.

GPC +1.27% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Genuine Parts held firm as auto parts demand proves recession-resistant. Defensive positioning working.

VLO +1.08% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Third straight day of gains. Refining crack spreads continue to widen on elevated crude. Now up over 7% in three sessions.

OKE +0.99% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

ONEOK benefited from the energy complex rally. Midstream infrastructure demand remains structurally strong.

DECLINERS

MARA –5.60% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Bitcoin slid 1.6% and crypto miners amplified the downside. Marathon dropped to $8.77 after Wednesday's +7.27% surge.

KEYS –5.45% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Keysight plunged on the AI chip permit headline from Bloomberg. Test equipment is first in line for any export restriction impact.

HUT –5.26% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gave back a chunk of Wednesday's +13.89% gain. Crypto miners remain the highest-beta names in the portfolio.

MATX –5.16% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Matson cratered on shipping disruption fears. Container shipping rates are volatile with Hormuz traffic frozen.

AEM –4.83% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold miners sold off again as gold fell 0.9%. Agnico has now dropped over 13% from last week's highs.

LRCX –3.73% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lam Research fell on the AI chip permit news. The semi equipment chain remains acutely sensitive to regulatory headlines.

EIX –3.61% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Edison International dropped sharply. Utilities sold off as rising Treasury yields pressured rate-sensitive sectors.

CAT –3.54% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Caterpillar continued its week-long slide to $706. Tariff headwinds plus oil-driven cost inflation pressuring margins.

HOLDINGS NEWS

Broadcom crushed Q1 after the bell: $2.05 EPS vs. $1.88 est., revenue $19.3B vs. $19.18B est. Q2 guide of $22B blew away the $20.56B consensus. AI semiconductor revenue hit $8.4B (+106% YoY). CEO Hock Tan sees AI chip revenue exceeding $100B by 2027. AVGO +6% after hours. Directly bullish for LRCX, ADI, QCOM, NXPI, and TEL.

Iran tanker strike: IRGC Navy claimed a missile hit on an American oil tanker in the northern Persian Gulf. Crude surged 3%. Hundreds of ships remain stuck despite U.S. escort promises. Oil could test $80+ if disruption persists.

Nonfarm payrolls tomorrow. Consensus 130K jobs, unemployment 4.3%. A hot print could push yields higher and pressure equities further. A soft print would reinforce rate-cut hopes ahead of the March 18 FOMC.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✗ TRAIL

–1.49%

vs. DVY –0.90% | IWS –1.41%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

–1.58%

vs. IUSG –0.17%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +9.47% vs DVY +8.44% / IWS +6.21%

Growth +0.81% vs IUSG –3.04%